GFH1000: In Dialogue with Humanity

Guidelines on Reflective Journal

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A: Introduction

Below are some points to bear in mind when writing a reflective journal.

1) At the top of the page, state: (1) the course code and course title, (2) your name and student number, (3) the date, and the number of the question you are addressing. Adopt the following format: Times New Roman/宋體, or 新明細體; font size 12; 1.5 line spacing. (See below [p.2] for a sample.)

2) Try always to read *closely* (i.e., attentively and in detail) and analyze passages in the selected classic text that are relevant to the question you address.

3) A long and detailed introduction may be a good practice when writing a long term paper, but not advisable for a reflective journal, which has a much lower word limit. One or two short sentences as introduction are usually enough.

4) Support your points by referring to the relevant passages. For example, you may want to make a point that Athena's dialogue with Telemachus is very important to the young man. You should show that your point is valid by referring to the text. Which line or phrase, from which book or books, suggests your point? You may paraphrase it (i.e., express the meaning in your own words), or make a direct quotation, such as: "Athena put courage in Telemachus' heart" (1:338). If the relevant passage is long, do not quote it in full. Either quote the most representative line(s), or summarize it.

5) Always remember to give the source (i.e., the location) of each passage that you quote, paraphrase or summarize in presenting the writer's view or in support of your argument. For the *Odyssey*, you state the source by giving the book and line number, e.g., 1:338, 1:121-125 or 1:220 f. (i.e., line 220 and the following ones in Book 1.).

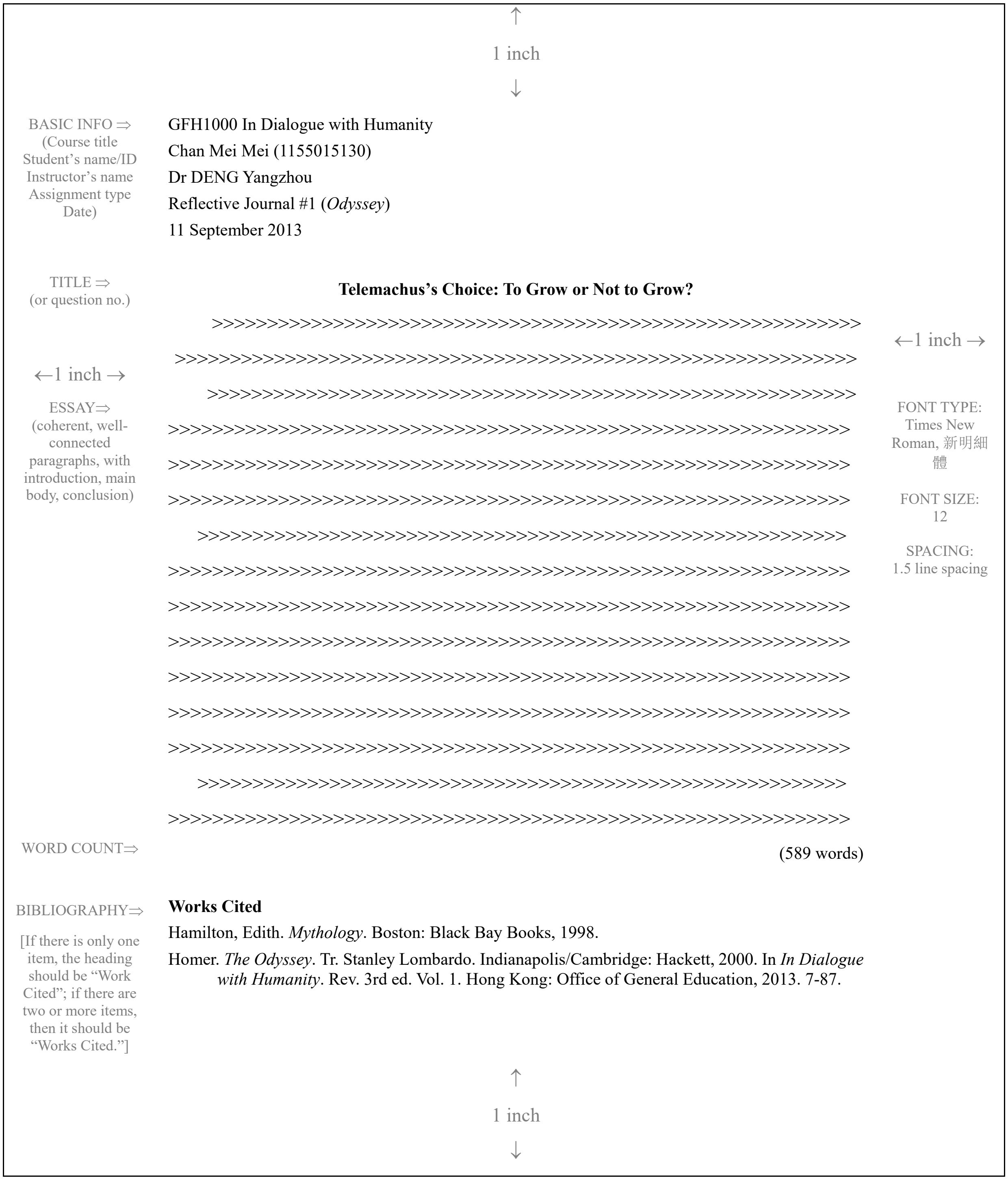
6) You may use sources other than the course book to clarify or support your points. This may be rare for reflective journals due to the word limit, but in case you do, please, again, remember to name the source. **Using or quoting other people's works or ideas is a general practice in academic writing; but quoting and using them without naming the source is an act of plagiarism**. Let us learn to be responsible for our own work and respect others'.

7) Do not number your points by using I, II, etc. (or 1, 2, 3, etc.). This is a common practice for papers of the humanities. Sometimes we see numberings when the papers are very long. The numbering usually helps divide the long paper into smaller sections. For our purpose here – a short reflective journal – try to connect your points with words such as "first," "second," etc., or with conjunctions ("and," "or," "but," "nor," "so," "yet," "for") or connectives ("In addition,, "Moreover," etc.).

8) You can write in Chinese or English, but do not use mixed languages, e.g.「正如雅典娜（Athena）所說，奧德修斯 "understands the correct order of things"。」If you write in Chinese, it is good practice – though not necessary – that you give the English transliteration of the proper names (such as those of characters, places etc.). But you should translate the passages you quote into Chinese if that's your chosen language for the journal. In the same way, if you decide to write in English for the texts that we read in Chinese, you would have to translate the quotations into English. You can of course make use of existing English translations from

the library. Again, remember to include the name of the translator in your reference.

B: Standard Layout (A4 sheet)



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1 inch
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BASIC INFO ⇒
(Course title
Student's name/ID
Instructor's name
Assignment type
Date)

GFH1000 In Dialogue with Humanity
Chan Mei Mei (1155015130)
Dr DENG Yangzhou
Reflective Journal #1 (*Odyssey*)
11 September 2013

TITLE ⇒
(or question no.)

Telemachus's Choice: To Grow or Not to Grow?

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ESSAY⇒
(coherent, well-connected paragraphs, with introduction, main body, conclusion)

FONT TYPE:
Times New Roman, 新明細體

FONT SIZE:
12

SPACING:
1.5 line spacing

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WORD COUNT⇒

(589 words)

BIBLIOGRAPHY⇒

[If there is only one item, the heading should be "Work Cited"; if there are two or more items, then it should be "Works Cited."]

Works Cited

Hamilton, Edith. *Mythology*. Boston: Black Bay Books, 1998.

Homer. *The Odyssey*. Tr. Stanley Lombardo. Indianapolis/Cambridge: Hackett, 2000. In *In Dialogue with Humanity*. Rev. 3rd ed. Vol. 1. Hong Kong: Office of General Education, 2013. 7-87.

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C: Question Pool

9: *Waiting for the Dawn*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Dawn*, e.g. “ (11).
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-9.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1. In the selected text from the *Analects*, Ji Kang asked Confucius about government. Confucius replied, "To govern means to rectify. If you lead on the people with correctness, who will dare not to be correct?" (12,17) (季康子问政于孔子。孔子对曰：”政者，正也。子帅以正，孰敢不正？”)
Study Huang Zongxi’s writing on ”the Prince”, and make an elaboration of the Confucian sayings in accordance with Huang’s ideas.
2. Liang Qichao (梁启超) once said *Waiting for the Dawn* contains democratic thoughts. How do you judge it in accordance with your reading and understanding of the text selected in the textbook?

10: *Social Contract*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Social Contract*, e.g. “(I, II, 12-16)”.
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-10.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1. Rousseau wrote the famous sentence right at the beginning of his Social Contract “Man is born free, but everywhere he is in chains.” (SC, I, 1) What is the meaning of this sentence? Why is man everywhere in chains, and what are these chains? Are these chains necessary?
2. Obviously Rousseau and Huang hold difference attitudes toward the role of people in political affairs. Can you give a general characterization of the difference?
3. What is the role of a legislator? (SC, I, VII) Why does Rousseau propose that there should be a legislator?

11: *Wealth of Nations*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Wealth of Nations*, e.g. “(I, 12-16)”.
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-11.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

1. Smith wrote in Chapter I, 15, that division of labor leads to “universal opulence” which extends itself to the lowest ranks of the people in a “well-governed society”. Why is he so optimistic, and what is the key feature of a “well-governed society”?
2. In Chapter II, 18, Smith believes that “it is not from the *benevolence* of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker, that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest.” What is his argument? Do you think this encouragement of self-love acceptable in terms of Aristotle’s negative ideas toward material self-love?

12: ***Manuscripts***

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the two texts, e.g. “ (I. 10) ” and (“Wages of Labour,” p.457), respectively.
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-12.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1. Study Smith and Marx’s treatment of wages of labour under free market, and give a brief reconstruction of Marx’s criticism of Smith or political economists on this issue.
2. Study Marx’s conception of human being as species-being, and review his idea of the differences between human beings and animals as species-beings.